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Curriculum-lecture-notes

Curriculum studies (Kibabii Diploma Teachers Training College)

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BUNGOMA TEACHERS TRAINING INSTITUTE

DIPLOMA PRIMARY TEACHER EDUCATION (DPTE) AND DPTE UPGRADING

PROGRAMMES

STUDENTS' COURSE BOOK FOR;

CURRICULUM STUDIES

KENYA INSTITUTE OF CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

2021

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Understanding the Meaning of Education

"Education" is derived from the Latin words "*educare*" and "*educere*". *Educare* refers to "to bring up' or "to nourish", whereas the word "*educere*" means to "to bring forth" or "to draw out"..

There is a tendency to assume that when different people talk about education, they all mean the same thing. It is for this reason that a definition for education is important to explore. No single definition or meaning however can be assigned to the term education.

Historically, philosophers, educationists and great thinkers have tried their best to define education.

The definitions of education given by the great philosophers and educationists can broadly be categorized into three major trends:

Education as a Spiritual Pursuit
Education: Development of Innate Human Potentialities
Education; Social Orientation of the Human Being.

Categories of education

Education can be gained in several forms through schools, life experiences and extra-curricular activities. Education has no specifications or boundaries assigned to it. Therefore, it can be broadly classified under three categories: -

Formal Education
Informal Education
Non-formal Education

Following are the details about each category.

Formal Education

Formal education is the one that works under the framework set by individual boards of education. The orderly learning environment includes educational institutions, classrooms, specially trained teachers, teaching equipment, extra-curricular activities, competitions, examinations and a curriculum or syllabus. Formal education, as the name suggests, is very structured in natures as proper guidelines are laid, and the students are expected to work under these guidelines.

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Formal education is followed in schools, colleges and other courses that follow a specific type of coursework. Some of its characteristics are as follows: -

A proper chronologically designed structure based on the hierarchy is followed.

Syllabus and books are assigned correctly.

The schedule is maintained and followed.

Regular exams and tests are conducted.

Fees are applied, and the students work in a disciplined organisation.

Informal Education

Informal education is the type of knowledge that one gains through several life experiences. It is the unstructured education where learning takes place through imitation, observation and participation.

It is the life-long process by which every person acquires and accumulates knowledge, skills, attitudes and insights etc from daily experience and exposure to the environment at, home, school, at work at pay.

It is generally unorganized and often unsystematic.

Learning to drive, cook, bathe oneself, and relating with people are some examples of informal education. Informal education is gained under the influence of society and the community.

Non-Formal Education

Non-formal education is any organized systematic educational activity carried on outside the framework of the formal system to provide selected types of learning to particular sub-groups in the population adult as well as children.

It is organized – has syllabus in place

It is systematic – already structured

It happens outside the education system.

A proper framework can be developed in making this education more mainstream.

Examples may include initiation ceremonies, dowry negotiations, boy-scouts, public speaking etc.

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Education and Schooling

Schooling:

This is the act of physically attending an institution of formal learning, for example a primary or a secondary school (Oluoch:2006). It involves systematic promotion through the grade ranges governing a learning institution with the assumption that at the end of institutionalized cycle some learning will have taken place. Schooling may also mean the casual process of attending an institution of leaning in the formal education system with the aim of gaining something worthwhile. Education involves more than schooling although the latter may be a process in the former.

There are four main dimensions of schooling:

Intellectual dimension: This dimension deals issues of the acquisition of knowledge, comprehension of knowledge and love and desire for knowledge.

Social dimension: Aims in this area relates to person-to-person interaction person to world interaction, and person to self-interaction.

Personal dimension: aims of education should provide guidance to planners so that they can in turn plan for experiences which can enhance self-actualization in individuals.

Productive dimension: Aims should provide guidelines to the school system so that these systems can organize the types of educational encounters that will help the individual to become a productive member in the society.

Education:

From the Latin word *educare* which means to bring up and *educere* which means to bring forth (Aggarwal: 2004). Education therefore means both to bring forth and to bring up with recourse to the norms of the society. Education as such is the process of acquiring habits, attitudes and skills which will enable one to lead worthwhile life. This is done by leading one out of ignorance by extracting his or her best potential and showing direction to the worthy experiences and practices of humanity. In this case education becomes the process of drawing out the best of the individuals mental, physical, spiritual and social faculties with the view of enhancing the development of those characteristics desired by the society.

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Education is not about certificates and degrees. Education is about how a person relates to life. Education opens the mind, encourages a search for truth and develops a mind that can engage critically with many different ideas.

Who is an educated person?

Education is meant to open the mind, encourage a search for truth and develops a mind that can engage critically with many different ideas.

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As stated earlier, education is difficult to define. However, being educated implies a criterion which the processes involved must satisfy in addition to the demand that something valuable must be developed. In other words, first of all, the individual who is educated:

shall care about valuable things involved and he
shall achieve relevant standards.

The Goals of Education

This is what education intends to achieve. They may be social and individual ideals. It is these ideals which can generally be referred to as the goals of education. O'Connor (1957) identifies the generally accepted goals of education:xd

To provide men and women with the skills that will enable them to live responsibly.
To enable individuals to be self-reliant.
To awaken an interest and a taste for knowledge.
To make men and women critical.
To enable men and women develop appreciation for moral and cultural achievements of mankind.

The Goals of education are important because foals help both the curriculum planner and the teacher in decision – making in various ways. Mainly, they help to:

To select the general programme content.
To decide on relevant subject areas for the courses already identified for realizing the broad aims of education.
To decide on specific subject content, experiences and related exposures in a subject area so as to promote the understanding of that subject at a relevant level of the school system e.g., Form 2 Mathematics
To decide on specific instructional experiences for a single lesson or through other exposures within the framework of the school timetable.

Functions of Education - The Kenyan Case

Education in Kenya should;

Foster nationalism, patriotism and promote national unity:

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Though Kenya's people belong to different communities, races and religions, they must be able to live and interact as Kenyans. Kenya should also foster patriotism in order to make a positive contribution to the nation

Promote the social, economic, technological and industrial needs for national development:

Education in Kenya should produce citizens with skills, knowledge, expertise and personal qualities that are required to support a growing economy which is need of adequate domestic manpower.

On technological and industrial needs, education should produce learners with the necessary skills and attitudes for industrial development.

Curriculum should include learning activities that enable children to acquire basic technological knowledge, skills and attitudes. These skills include exploration, discovery, initiative and creativity.

Promote individual development and self-fulfilment

The curriculum should provide opportunities for learners to identify their abilities and talents and apply them in their daily lives for individual and societal fulfilment. Curriculum development should integrate the learners' needs, group needs and provide experiences for individual development and self-fulfilment. It should identify children's needs individually and in groups and provide learning experiences that enable them to develop to their fullest.

Promote sound moral and religious values.

Moral and religious (Spiritual) values are necessary for a disciplined, reliable and responsible member of the society. It is the role of education, through the curriculum to provide opportunities for the acquisition and development of relevant knowledge, skills, and attitudes associated with sound morals and spiritual values. The curriculum should instil in children religious and moral values such as patience, humility, love, respect for others, kindness and mercy.

Promote social equality and responsibility

For a country to develop, its entire citizenrgy, irrespective of gender, race, ability or ethnic background, should be given an opportunity to contribute to its development.

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Education through the curriculum, should promote equality and foster a sense of social responsibility in learners. It should address social disparities and challenges that exist in the society to foster social equality.

Curriculum should be designed in such a way that children are provided with experiences that give them opportunity to be responsible.

Promote respect for and development of Kenya's rich and varied culture.

Education through the curriculum should instil in the learners an understanding of past and present cultures and their valid place in the contemporary society.

The learners should also be able to blend and learn to accept the diversity of our cultural heritage and use this diversity to create a cohesive stable and modern society.

Promote international consciousness and foster positive attitudes towards other nations.

Kenya is part of the international community. Education therefore should lead the learners of a country to accept and strengthen memberships in the national community with all the obligations and responsibilities, rights, benefits that this membership entails.

Promote positive attitude towards good health and environmental protection

Education, through the curriculum, should inculcate in the learner the value of good health in order to avoid indulging in activities that may lead to physical or mental ill health. It should also foster a positive attitude towards environmental development and conservation. It should help learners to appreciate the need for a healthy environment.

Relationship Between Education and Curriculum

In attempting to meet the needs of the society, education may as well provide individuals with skills which are not relevant to the progress of their society. To avoid that, education must come up with well-designed programs that are meant to assist in achieving the aforesaid goals. It is these programmes that are referred as the curriculum.

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Meaning and Definition of Curriculum Concepts, Theories and Models

Traditional and Emerging Definition of Curriculum

Traced to its roots, the term curriculum is derived from the Latin word *curere* which means a racecourse taken by horses. By the seventeenth century, the University of Glasgow also referred to its "course" of study as a "curriculum", producing the first known use of the term in English in 1633. By the nineteenth century, European universities routinely referred to their curriculum to describe both the complete course of study and particular courses and their content. By 1824, the word was defined as "a course, especially a fixed course of study at a college, university, or school."

In today's general definition in education, curriculum may be taken to mean a racecourse taken by the educational process. Hence, curriculum represents a course of subjects covered by learners in their race towards a certain educational goal or target. Learners therefore pass through barriers to attain their end results.

Hilda Taba (1962) Defines 'curriculum' as "*containing a statement of the aims and of the specific objectives; it indicates some selection and organisation of content; it either implies or manifests certain patters of learning and teaching.*"

Because the objective demand or the content organisation requires it includes a program of evaluation of the outcomes

Narrow and Broad Definitions of Curriculum

Curriculum definitions have developed along a continuum from narrow to broad ones.

Broad definitions:

See ***curriculum as a process***. The process includes the thinking behind coming up with 'a package' and the continuous effort of making it serve the needs of society. It goes beyond the classroom and the subject content including the values, attitudes and experiences of students inside and outside the school. Broad definitions also include all dimensions for curriculum: the formal /expressed; non - formal; informal/hidden, formal and emergent dimensions. The broader definitions consider how the content is to be presented and assessed. Hence broader perspective will consider the knowledge pedagogy (teaching

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methods) and assessment procedures. As a process the term curriculum takes into consideration:

All the learning experiences for the learner
Techniques and methodologies used by the teacher
The teaching and learning resources: materials, equipment and facilities
Administrative procedures under which the implementation occurs.

Some broad definitions offered by various scholars include the following:

The learner's engagements with various aspects of the environment which have been planned under the direction of the school. (Doll, 1992).

All the learning of students which is planned and directed by the school to attain educational goals (Tyler, 1949)

Everything that is planned to enable the student develop the desired knowledge, skills and attitudes (Oluoch, 1982)

Curriculum involves "all subjects taught and all activities provided by the school and may include the time devoted to teach each subject and activity. (The Kenya Education Act,1986)

Curriculum refers to all of the teaching and learning activities that take place in learning institutions to achieve the set goals. Curriculum therefore is considered as the sum total of all experiences a learner undergoes (Bishop, 1995).

Curriculum as that reconstruction of knowledge and experiences systematically developed under the auspices of the school or any educational institution to enable the learner increase his control of knowledge and experiences (Tanner and Tanner, 1980).

Narrow definitions:

See ***curriculum as a plan, program, course of study*** or a package that can be used to bring about learning. It deals with subject content and in this context is restricted to the classroom. The narrow category sees curriculum as a package that contain the total of the syllabuses of an institution. From the narrow perspective, curriculum can be defined as:

Course of study (Oxford Chambers' Dictionary)

All the courses given in a school, college, etc., or a particular course of study in one subject (Cambridge Dictionary)

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A plan for learning (Hilda Taba, 1962)

Presented instructional content (Marcia, 1965)

Plan for teaching and instruction - it can be viewed as the blueprint for instruction (Pratt, 1994)

A programme of activities designed so that pupils will attain as far as possible certain educational ends or objectives. (Richmond, 1974: in Urebvu, 1990:3)

Curriculum as a field of Study or Discipline

Besides being a plan of instruction, curriculum is also a field of study. As a field of study, curriculum is an aspect of knowledge which has developed into a disciplined area of study. That is, it consists of knowledge organized for instruction with substantive knowledge content which can be passed on through instruction and which grows through research and other modes of inquiry. Curriculum qualifies for reference as a field of study because:

It is appropriate for teaching.

It is available for learning.

It is analysable and can be simplified.

It can be synthesized and coordinated.

It is dynamic and has grown through research.

It has a rationale i.e., goals to achieve e.g., learning activities, organization and evaluation of educational experiences.

Curriculum is made up of:

Foundations:

Philosophical foundations,

historical foundations,

psychological foundations,

and social foundations,

domains of knowledge,

as well as its research theories

and principles.

Curriculum as a field of study or discipline should be scholarly and theoretical. It is concerned with broad, historical, philosophical social issues and academics. it is “all the learning which is planned and guided by the school, whether it is carried on in groups or individually, inside or outside the school.

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Curriculum as a programme of Instruction

The curriculum is the program of instruction. It should be based on both standards and best practice research. It should be the framework that teachers use to plan instruction for their students.

Key Components and dimensions of the school curriculum

Elements/components are the basic principles of the curriculum. The nature of the elements and the manner in which they are organized may comprise what we term as curriculum design.

COMPONENT 1: Curriculum Aims, Goals and Objectives

Aims of Education

The term 'aims' is often used interchangeably with the terms, goals, ends, functions, general objectives, and purposes. However, there are differences amongst them.

Aims are general statements that provide both shape and direction to the more specific actions designed to achieve some future product of behaviour. Aims are starting points that allow educators to rally behind them. Aims serve the crucial functions of guiding education, but they cannot be directly observed or evaluated. Aim is an expression of a long-term purpose, usually over the course of one or more years.

Goals of Education

At a lower level than aims are curriculum goals to guide the educational planners in the task of curriculum planning.

Whereas aims provide guidance as to direction they do not indicate the actual destination itself, but goals do. ***Goals*** delimit educational activities so that particular ends or purposes are achieved. Goals are statements of end points or outcomes of education – i.e., statements of purpose. Goals are derived from various aims and thus provide teachers and curriculum decision makers with broad statements of what they should accomplish in terms of student learning as a result of a particular subject or educational program.

Teachers are charged with responsibility of implementing the curriculum. Their knowledge of goals originates from the curriculum contexts through the ministry of education.

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Teachers receive such information/communication from KICD through the Ministry of Education's inspectorate. The ministry's documents are in the form of teachers guides, advice on relevant textbooks for various courses offered as well as report, on the approach to individual subject areas. Public opinions can influence the nature of goals for the educational system.

Objective of Education

Within the context of educational aims and goals, objectives are formulated. They indicate in more specific terms the outcomes of the curriculum or project being considered.

Educational objectives can be of two sorts; those that describe school – wide outcomes and those that are more specific and describes behaviours to be attained in a particular unit, a subject course, or a particular grade level program.

Objectives are statements that enable curriculum decision makers – curriculum decision-makers – curriculum developers, teachers, and even students to identify the particular intents of a particular action.

A meaningful objective is one that communicates effectively to the reader the instructional intent or behaviour of the objective as well as specific learning outcomes.

<u>COMPONENT II: Curriculum content or subject matter.</u>

Saylor (1981) defined content as those facts, observations, data, perceptions, discernments, sensibilities, designs, and solutions drawn from what the minds of men have comprehended from experience and those constructs of the mind that reorganize and those constructs of the mind that reorganize and re-arrange these products of experience into lore, ideas, concepts, generalizations, principles, and solutions.

The word content is used interchangeably with terms such as subject matter, knowledge, concepts, and ideas.

The question *what?* shall be included for purposes of learning are what is termed as the appropriate content, knowledge, theories all the information to be learned.

<u>COMPONENT III: Curriculum experience/learning experience.</u>

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It answers what instructional strategies, resources and activities will be employed. Instructional strategies and methods are the core of the curriculum. These instructional strategies and methods will put into action the goals and use of the content in order to produce an outcome. These would convert the written curriculum to instruction.

Mastery is the function of the teacher direction and student activity with the teacher supervision.

COMPONENT IV: Curriculum Evaluation

Evaluation is a process or cluster of processes that people perform in order to gather data that will enable them to decide whether to accept, change, or eliminate something. i.e. the curriculum in general or an educational text book in particular.

Official, Actual and Hidden Curriculum

The **official curriculum** is what is published in the prospectus, this will include the individual courses, the content of these courses including the syllabus, awarding body, number of hours of teaching required, etc. contained in official curriculum documents, list of courses, syllabuses and prospectuses. The official curriculum incorporates core knowledge and values students are expected to learn. It provides a map of theories, beliefs and intentions about schooling, teaching, learning and knowledge.

Formal curriculum is referred to as all the work that teachers plan and use with students. This curriculum meets specified objectives of educating identified groups of learners or students in their varying settings. In other words, formal curriculum is the selected written programs or courses students go through. In this case, we use the term formal curriculum narrowly to mean the actual course of study, the planned content, teaching, evaluation methods, syllabi, and other materials used in any educational setting from lecture halls to labs to seminar rooms. Also included are formal policy statements, regulations, expectations, and competencies for every educational cohort conceivable

Actual Curriculum refers to both written and unwritten syllabuses from which students encounter learning experiences (Tanner and Tanner 1975). Learning experiences can be selected from other sources rather than the prescribed, official and formal syllabuses. The

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actual curriculum is the total sum of what students learn and teachers teach from both formal and informal curricula. The actual curriculum is the reality, ideally this will be as close to the official curriculum as possible, but is not always possible.

A **hidden curriculum** is a set of lessons "which are learned but not openly intended" to be taught in school such as the norms, values, and beliefs conveyed in both the classroom and social environment. Much of what is studied is hiding in plain sight. More is taught and learned in schools than specified in the established curriculum of textbooks and teacher manuals

Methods of Curriculum Inquiry or Study

Curriculum inquiry is a species of educational research or inquiry. As such, it addresses particular kinds of educational research questions related to formulating curriculum policies, developing curriculum programs, and enacting these policies and programs. Curriculum inquiry involves identifying those curriculum questions that are amenable to inquiry, knowing what form of inquiry to use in attempting to answer those particular questions, and carrying out the appropriate processes of inquiry in order to obtain those answer.

The purpose of systematic and continuous curriculum inquiry as striving to arrive at answers to four basic questions:

What should be the aims and objectives of a curriculum?

What should be the content and the methods of a curriculum?

How should the achievement of curriculum aims and objectives be assessed?

What gained experiences can be fed back into a curriculum?

Questions that arise in the field of curriculum inquiry are answerable by using any or all of these forms of inquiry:

Analytic

Hermeneutic

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Ampliative

Theoretical

Speculative

Normative

Historical

Critical

Scientific

Evaluative

Ethnographic

Integrative

Narrative

Deliberative

Aesthetic

Action

Phenomenological

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Factors that influence the School Curriculum

Curriculum development is influenced by many factors. Factors affecting curriculum development include philosophical, psychological, societal or social, political, economical, educational, technological and gender factors etc. A brief description of these factors is as follows;

Philosophical Factors

Based upon fundamental beliefs that arise from one's philosophy of Education, curricular decisions involve consideration of several topics and issues. Precisely for this reason, we consider philosophy one of the major foundation areas in curriculum.

Studying philosophy helps us deal with our own personal systems of beliefs and values the way we perceive the world around us and how we define what is important to us. Hence, a study of the philosophy of education in terms of curriculum development is essential. In essence, educational philosophies influence, and to a large extent determine, our educational decisions and alternatives. Those who are responsible for curricular decisions, therefore, should be clear about what they believe. If we are unclear or confused about our own beliefs, then our curricular plans are bound to be unclear and confusing.

Psychological Factors

The purpose of psychology is to study human behaviour. Psychology contributes to curriculum planning by providing teachers with information concerning the nature of students, the nature of the process involved in learning, the motivation, personality and individual differences of students, the value of teaching methods and teaching effectiveness.

Social or Societal Factors

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The purpose of sociology is the analysis of organized human relationship. Its major contribution to curriculum has been the making of decisions about the content of the curriculum and its main focus has been the understanding of the direction of social change and the socialization of the individual. Its method of working involves providing extensive information about the social background of students, promoting a realistic evaluation of the role of the teacher and school in social change. It increases teacher's flexibility, tolerance and awareness of methods of inquiry. It keeps in mind that primary school curriculum differs from secondary school curriculum. The needs of society play an important role in development of the curriculum, e.g., it should be emphasis on a technical based curriculum for the development of an industrialized society.

Political Factors

Politics has a certain impact on all spheres of life, and instability of politics leads to instability in everyday life. It usually defines goals and content; political considerations need to be admitted while curriculum development; and political decisions may change the requirements for curriculum development.

Governments need to promote nationalism, patriotism and ideologies. Therefore, have polices according to which they send out directives. The directives state the medium of instruction, the nature of the syllabus and the kind of textbook, etc.

Economic Factors

As compared to the schools in developed areas (such as urban areas) schools belonging to the lower economic strata cannot have the possibility of using modern equipment, e.g., the computer, due to financial constraints. This also leads to losing good teachers and other personnel to places offering better remuneration.

Educational Factors

In order to bring about effective learning modern and efficient methods of education should be used and for this we need trained and skilled teachers. We also need to keep co-curricular activities like sports, drama, debates, school trips, etc. as an integral part of the curriculum.

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Technological Factors

The influence of technological progress is observed in each sphere of life, and when the time for curriculum development comes, the technological point plays an important role.

Curriculum developers cannot ignore this technological progress and the influence it presents. Technological innovations may be applied to curriculum development in several ways “as a plan for the systematic use of various devices and media” and as the issue that “is found in models and procedures for the construction or development and evaluation of curriculum materials and instructional systems” (Print, 1993, p.55).

Gender Factors

The needs of each gender are also kept in mind for the development of curriculum. Although this is the age where women have gone into professions which were previously considered the domain of male gender and women are asking for equal rights, yet option should be left open, e.g., home economics for girls and technical education for boys, though these should not be strictly the domains of females or males respectively. In advanced countries where women enjoy a greater degree of freedom, a variety of educational institutions exist that separately cater the male and female curriculum needs.

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Curriculum Design & Organisation

What is Curriculum Design

Curriculum design is a statement which identifies:

> "*...the elements of the curriculum, states what their relationships are to each other and indicates the principles of organization and the requirements of that organization for the administrative conditions under which it is to operate. A design needs to be supported with a curriculum theory which establishes the sources to consider and the principles to apply*". ~ Hilda Taba

The elements referred to in the above quotation are:

Objectives
Content
Learning experiences
Teaching strategies
Evaluation

Malusu (1997) states that, design is the way in which the curricular elements namely, the objectives, learning experiences, teaching learning strategies, resources and evaluation procedures have been selected and organized in order to facilitate learning.

Curriculum design is largely concerned with issues such as what to include in the curriculum and how to present it in such a way that the curriculum can be implemented with understanding and success (Barlow et al., 1984). Therefore, curriculum design refers to how the components of the curriculum have been arranged in order to facilitate learning (Shiundu & Omulando, 1992).

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Theories of Curriculum Design

Curriculum perspectives are theories of knowledge which are an important source of curriculum decisions. What goes into the curriculum depends heavily on these perspectives. There are four curriculum perspectives that we will explore in the following section:

rationalist (ii) empiricist (iii) pragmatist (iv) existentialist.

It is important to consider each perspective as it relates to the following:

the learner
the teacher
methodology
curriculum.

Rationalists say:

True knowledge is achieved by the mind.
Knowledge is a series of revelations.

Empiricists think:

True knowledge is derived from evidence.
Authentic knowledge comes through the senses.

Pragmatists believe that:

Knowledge is hypothetical and changing constantly.
Knowledge is experienced.
Knowledge cannot be imposed on the learner.
Knowledge is a personal activity.
Knowledge is socially constructed.

Existentialists or phenomenologists conclude that:

Knowledge is personal and subjective.
Knowledge is one's own unique perception of one's world.
Education should be less formal.
Curricula should be diverse, not common for all.

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Perspectives	Learner	Teacher	Method	Curriculum
Rationalist	Recipient of information	Source of ideas, facts and information	Drilling Lecturing Subject-based	Subject matter of symbol and idea
Empiricist	Recipient of information	Demonstrator of process	Lecturing Teacher-centred	Subject matter of the physical world
Pragmatist	Experiences knowledge	Researcher, project director	Inquiry Participatory Problem-solving	Problem solving Hypothetical Subject to change Problems Projects
Existentialist	Ultimate chooser, search for personal identity	Facilitator of choices	Inquiry Discovery	Subject matter of choices Not rigid

Adapted from Beach, D. M., and Reinhatz, J. (1989: 106). *Supervision: Focus on Instruction*. New York: Harper and Row.

Figure 1: Summary of Curriculum Perspectives

Once you've determined what type of curriculum you want to create, it's time to choose an approach.

A given teaching-learning situation focuses on a particular type of learning activity: mastery of subject matter, addressing a social problem etc. How these learning situations are organized indicates a curricular approach. "A curricular approach is defined as a pattern of organization used in making decisions about the various aspects of a teaching-learning situation." (Beane, et. al. 1986). These approaches are categorized into four major groups:

Subject Centered Approach
Broad Fields Approach
Problem Centered Approach
Learner Centered Approach

Subject-Centered Curriculum Design

Subject-centered curriculum design revolves around a particular subject matter or discipline. For example, a subject-centered curriculum may focus on math or biology. This type of curriculum design tends to focus on the subject rather than the individual.

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Subject-centered curriculum design describes what needs to be studied and how it should be studied. **Core-curriculum** is an example of a subject-centered design that can be standardized across schools, states, and the country as a whole. In standardized core curricula, teachers are provided a pre-determined list of things that they need to teach their students, along with specific examples of how these things should be taught. You can also find subject-centered designs in large university classes in which teachers focus on a particular subject or discipline.

The primary drawback of subject-centered curriculum design is that it is not student-centered. In particular, this form of curriculum design is constructed without taking into account the specific learning styles of the students. This can cause problems with student engagement and motivation and may even cause students to fall behind in class.

Another method of organizing curricular components is combining two or more subjects from related fields into a broader field. The popularity of this approach in recent times is due to the following reasons:

Curriculum is not compartmentalized into rigid subject boundaries. Hence the information becomes more meaningful to the learners.

Teachers have greater flexibility to choose content.

Learners can see the interrelatedness of various subject areas in the curriculum. They can generalize knowledge across broad areas.

The Broad Fields Approach combines separate subjects from within a domain of knowledge. An example of such a correlation could be the Humanities programme which may be a combination of Literature, Art, History, and Music. or sometimes knowledge from two entirely different fields could be blended e.g., multi-cultural education is a broad field area, which draws information from Sociology, Psychology, History and Anthropology.

Learner-Centered Curriculum Design

In contrast, learner-centered curriculum design takes each individual's needs, interests, and goals into consideration. In other words, it acknowledges that students are not uniform and adjust to those student needs. Learner-centered curriculum design is meant to empower learners and allow them to shape their education through choices.

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Instructional plans in a learner-centered curriculum are differentiated, giving students the opportunity to choose assignments, learning experiences or activities. This can motivate students and help them stay engaged in the material that they are learning.

The drawback to this form of curriculum design is that it is labor-intensive. Developing differentiated instruction puts pressure on the teacher to create instruction and/or find materials that are conducive to each student's learning needs. Teachers may not have the time or may lack the experience or skills to create such a plan. Learner-centered curriculum design also requires that teachers balance student wants and interests with student needs and required outcomes, which is not an easy balance to obtain.

Problem-Centered Curriculum Design

Like learner-centered curriculum design, problem-centered curriculum design is also a form of student-centered design. Problem-centered curricula focus on teaching students how to look at a problem and come up with a solution to the problem. Students are thus exposed to real-life issues, which helps them develop skills that are transferable to the real world.

Problem-centered curriculum design increases the relevance of the curriculum and allows students to be creative and innovate as they are learning. The drawback to this form of curriculum design is that it does not always take learning styles into consideration.

In Kenya for example, some of the problem that may determine this kind of curriculum may include HIV/AIDS, pollution, terrorism, corruption, cattle rustling, road carnage, drug and child abuse, tribalism domestic violence etc. Content of such a design will cut across subjects because they are selected on account of their relevance.

Principles and Dimensions of Curriculum Design

Curriculum design has to be developed on the basis of certain dimensions like Scope, Integration, Sequence, Continuity, Articulation and Balance. These considerations will determine the shape of the curriculum, the kind of learning experiences it will provide, its extent, organizing content into a useful sequence, etc. Let us now examine these considerations for curriculum design.

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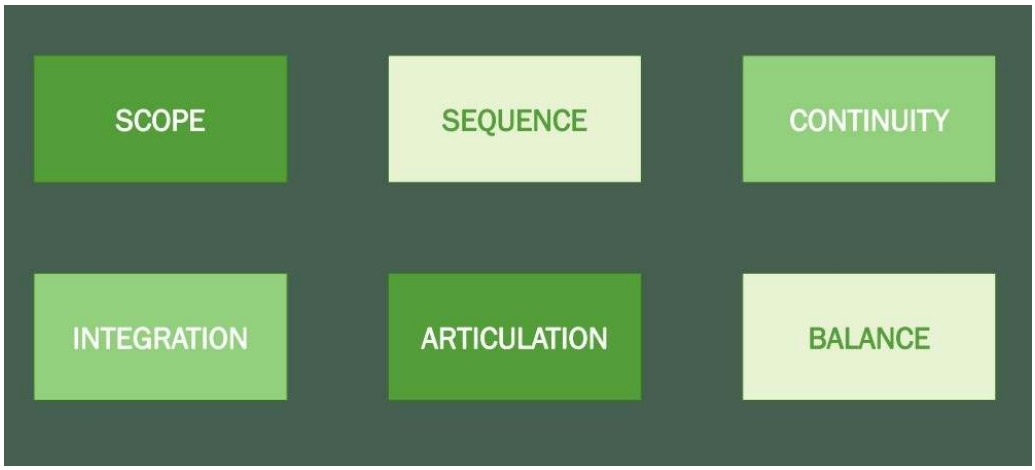

Figure 2: Dimensions of Curriculum Design

Scope

According to Saylor et. al. (1981), scope is defined as, "the breadth, variety and types of educational experiences that are to be provided to pupils as they progress through the school programme. Scope represents the latitudinal axis for selecting curriculum experiences."

Scope of a curriculum design determines the depth to which the subject matter has to be dealt with, the type of learning activities to be provided and decisions about the arrangement of curricular components.

Integration

Learning becomes meaningful when content from one field (e.g., Physics) is interrelated with content from another (e.g., Chemistry). The major task confronting a curriculum designer is to integrate learning experiences of the learner at a particular level of the curriculum. "It is an attempt to interrelate content with learning experiences and activities to ensure that students' needs are met." This refers to the horizontal relationships among various themes or topics in different subject areas.

Sequence

While arranging the components of curriculum a vertical sequence should be followed, i.e. there should be a vertical relationship between the curricular elements so as to enable continuous learning. There has been a longstanding debate over whether the sequence of content and experiences should be based on the logic of subject matter or on the way in which individuals process knowledge. Those who believe in arranging curricular components on psychological principles have based this belief on researches in human growth, development and learning. Piaget's research has provided a framework for sequencing

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content and activities and relating expectations to what we know about how individuals function at various cognitive levels. Kohlberg's research has provided a similar service regarding individuals' moral development and the ways in which individuals process types of moral issues and concepts.

Based on well-accepted learning principles, Smith, Stanley and Shores (1957) have given four bases for sequencing content. These are: -

Simple to complex learning: From teaching two-digit addition to teaching five-digit addition.
Part to whole or pre-requisite learning: From teaching digestive system to teaching the entire human body systems.
Whole to part: Teaching the concept of 'animal' and then teaching the concept of a 'dog'.
Chronological learning: Chronological occurrence of historical events.

Continuity

Continuity implies the repetition of such skills or ideas in the curriculum about which the learners should have in-depth knowledge. That means over a period of time the same kind of skills be brought into operation. For example, if the concept of addition is to be developed then content should provide recurring opportunity or exercises on addition to be practiced.

Articulation

Articulation refers to interrelatedness of concepts of a curriculum. The relation can be either vertical or horizontal. Vertical articulation occurs when certain lessons, topics or courses are related to those occurring later in the curriculum sequence.

For example, the form two chemistry curriculum could be designed so as to interrelate the concepts of Atomic Structure with those of Radioactivity. Horizontal articulation occurs between curricular components simultaneously. For example, when curriculum designers interrelate concepts of eleventh standard History and Political Science or Political Science and Sociology. However, interrelationships between subjects can be established only with difficulty. Hence it is difficult to achieve articulation in a curriculum.

Balance

Curriculum designers are also concerned that appropriate weightage be given to every aspect of the curriculum, so that a balanced curriculum emerges. A balanced curriculum is one that helps the learners to gain knowledge and utilize it to achieve their goals. Hence various curricular components, like subject

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matter, learning activities, learner interests, attitudes, values etc. should be given due consideration for optimal learning, based on learners' needs. A fully balanced curriculum is difficult to achieve since schools are slow in adapting to the changing needs of individuals and society.

Curriculum Development

What is Curriculum Development

This refers to all those processes and activates systematically undertaken by either an individual or an institution to come up with an educational programme. In some countries, curriculum development is not done centrally while in Kenya it is centralized and the body changed with the responsibility of developing the curriculum is the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development.

The curriculum development process systematically organizes what will be taught, who will be taught, and how it will be taught. Each component affects and interacts with other components. For example, what will be taught is affected by who is being taught (e.g., their stage of development in age, maturity, and education). Methods of how content is taught are affected by who is being taught, their characteristics, and the setting

Essential Considerations for Curriculum Development:

1. **issue/problem/need** is identified (**issue → what**),
2. **characteristics** and **needs** of **learners** (**target audience → who**),
3. changes intended for learners (**intended outcomes**/objectives → **what the learners will be able to do**),
4. the important and relevant **content** →(**what**),
5. **methods** to accomplish intended outcomes →(**how**),
6. **evaluation strategies** for methods, content, and intended outcomes →(**What works?**).

Components of Curriculum Development

The development of a curriculum goes through several stages. These stages are also referred to as phases and steps in curriculum development.

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Planning (Conceptualization)

Identify issue

Form curriculum development team

Conduct needs assessment and analysis

Construction (Content and Methods)

State intended outcomes

Select Content

Design the experiences

Implementation

Produce the Curriculum product

Test and revise curriculum

Recruit and train facilitators

Evaluation and Reporting

Design evaluation Strategies

Reporting and securing resources.

Curriculum Development Models

The models of curriculum development have aims and objectives that are based on the requirements of people, group of people and the society as a whole. Modeling is a way through which a curriculum development plan is defined. Basically, models are samples that provide guidelines to action and more or less set up for educational purpose.

Hilda Taba Curriculum Theory and Model (1962)

Hilda Taba was born in 1902, she was a curriculum theorist, Educator and reformer. Hilda Taba believed that those who teach curriculum should participate in developing it.

She believes that teachers should develop curriculum and that curriculum should not be handed down from higher authorities. She advocated what has been termed as the “grass-root approach.”

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She advocated teachers should take an inductive approach to curriculum development starting with specifics and building to a general design.

Hilda Taba noted seven major steps in the process of developing a curriculum:

Diagnosis of needs

Formulation of objectives

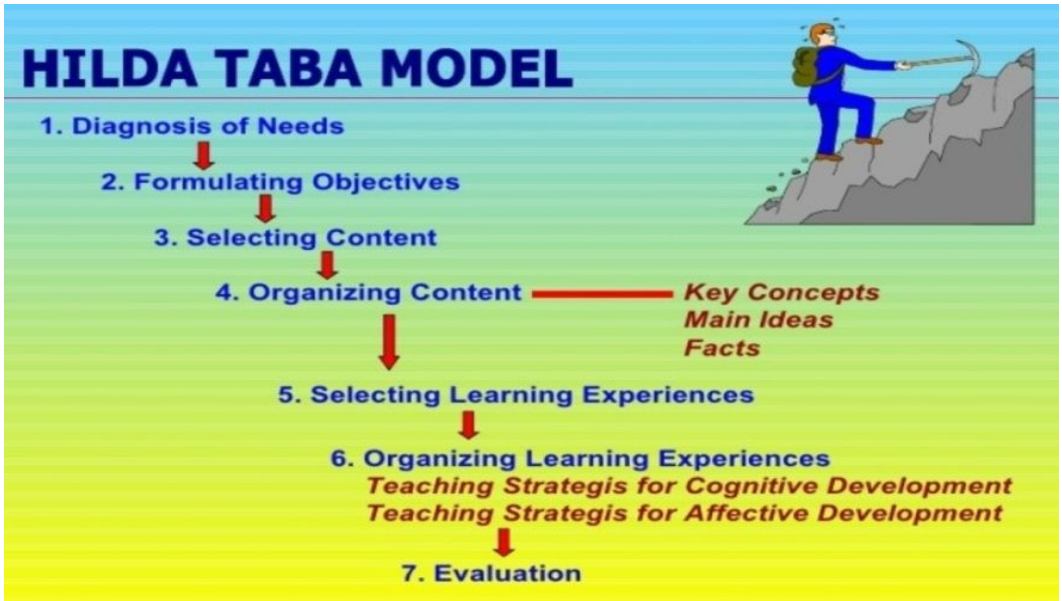
Selection of contents

Organization of contents

Selection of learning experiences

Organization of learning experiences

Evaluation and means of evaluation



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Diagnosis of needs

The teacher starts the process by identifying the needs of the students for whom the curriculum is to be planned.

Formulation of objectives.

Formulation of oobjectives should encompass the following areas:

Concepts or ideas to be learned.

Attitudes, sensitivities, and feelings to be developed.

Ways of thinking to be reinforced, strengthened or initiated

Habits and skills to be mastered.

Selection of Content

The objectives selected or created suggest the subject matter or content of the curriculum unit subject. Subject matter should be related to the grade level of the student.

Organization of Content

A teacher cannot just select content, but must organize it in some type of sequences taking into consideration the maturity of the learners, their academic achievement, and their interests.

Selection of learning experiences

Content must be presented to pupils or pupils must engage in an interaction with the content. To select learning experiences, Taba suggests that the teacher should ask a number of questions. For example:

Is the experience appropriate for learning the main ideas?

Does the experience promote “Active learning?”

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Is the experience appropriate to the students' maturity level?

Taba also felt that learning experiences should reflect a variety of experiences, including, "reading, writing, observing, doing research, analysing, discussing, tabulating, painting, constructing and dramatizing.

Organization of learning experiences.

Taba outlines a sequence for organizing learning experiences: –

Introduction: Introduction involves developing student interest and proving diagnostic evidence for the teacher.

Development: Development or study consists learning activities that are designed to develop various aspects of the subject and to provide needed factual material. These activities include "reading, research, analysis of data, committee work and study of various kinds

Generalization: Generalization refers to students attempts to put ideas together. e.g., comparing and contrasting and exploration of the reasons for similarities and differences.

Application or summary: Application or summary is the stage at which the student applies generalization to a larger framework.

Evaluation and Means of Evaluation

Involves determining whether objectives have been met, diagnosis of the curriculum plan, and assessment of any changes in student behaviour.

Ralph Tyler Model of Curriculum

Tyler Model of Curriculum was developed by the American educator Ralph Tyler in the 1940s. He introduced this method of curriculum development in his book Basic Principles of

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Curriculum and Instruction. It was one of the first models of curricula and a very simple model even used by modern educators.

Tyler model of curriculum describes how to formulate educational objectives, how to organise them, analyse them and adjust them so that the students are able to meet these objectives.

Basically, Tyler presented his curriculum rationale as four questions:

> *What educational purposes should the school seek to attain?*
>
> *What educational experiences can be provided that will likely attain these purposes?*
>
> *How can these educational experiences be effectively organised?*
>
> *How can we determine whether the purposes are being attained?*

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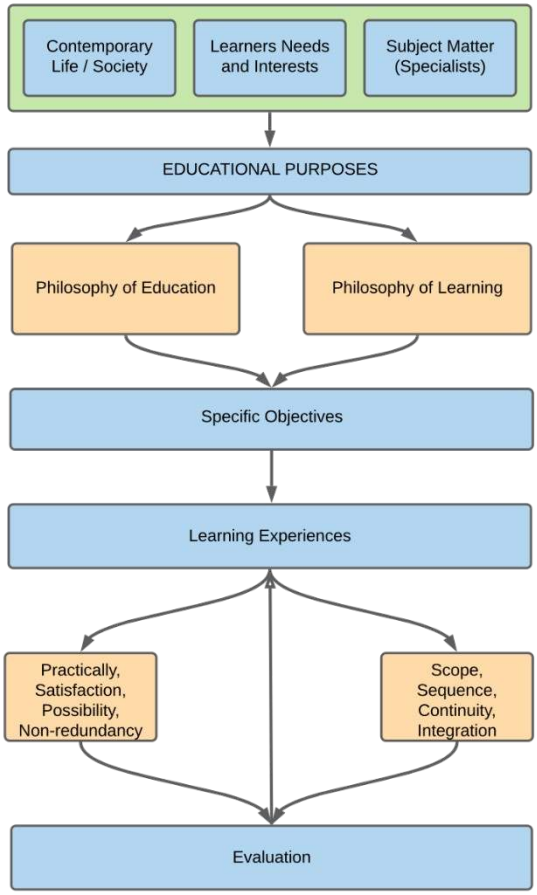

Comparison of Tyler's and Taba's rationale

Tyler's theory is deductive while Taba's is inductive. Tyler's approach argues from the administrator approach while Taba's reflects the teacher's approach. In essence, Tyler believes that administration should design the curriculum and the teachers implement it.

Taba believes that the teachers are aware of the students' needs; hence teachers should be the ones to develop the curriculum and implement in practice. Another name for Taba's is the *grass-roots* approach. However, her rationale does not start with objectives, as she believes that the demand for education in a particular society should be studied first.

Taba also pays attention to the selection of the content and its organization with an aim to provide students with an opportunity to learn with comprehension. Tyler lays the main stress on aims, evaluation and control. This approach may be perfect, perhaps, for market-oriented

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education, but inadequate for the development of responsible and creative individuals able to meet the challenges of the constantly changing circumstances. Many educational systems today, using Tyler's model, have come to crises and require reforms based on a totally different model of curriculum development.

The Wheeler Model

D.K. Wheeler developed a cyclic model in reaction to criticism leveled at Ralph Tyler's model. The latter was seen as being too simplistic and vertical. By being vertical, it did not recognize the relationship between various curriculum elements. His cyclic proposal was therefore aimed at highlighting the interrelatedness of the various curriculum elements. It also emphasizes the need to use feedback from evaluation in redefining the goals and objectives of the curriculum.

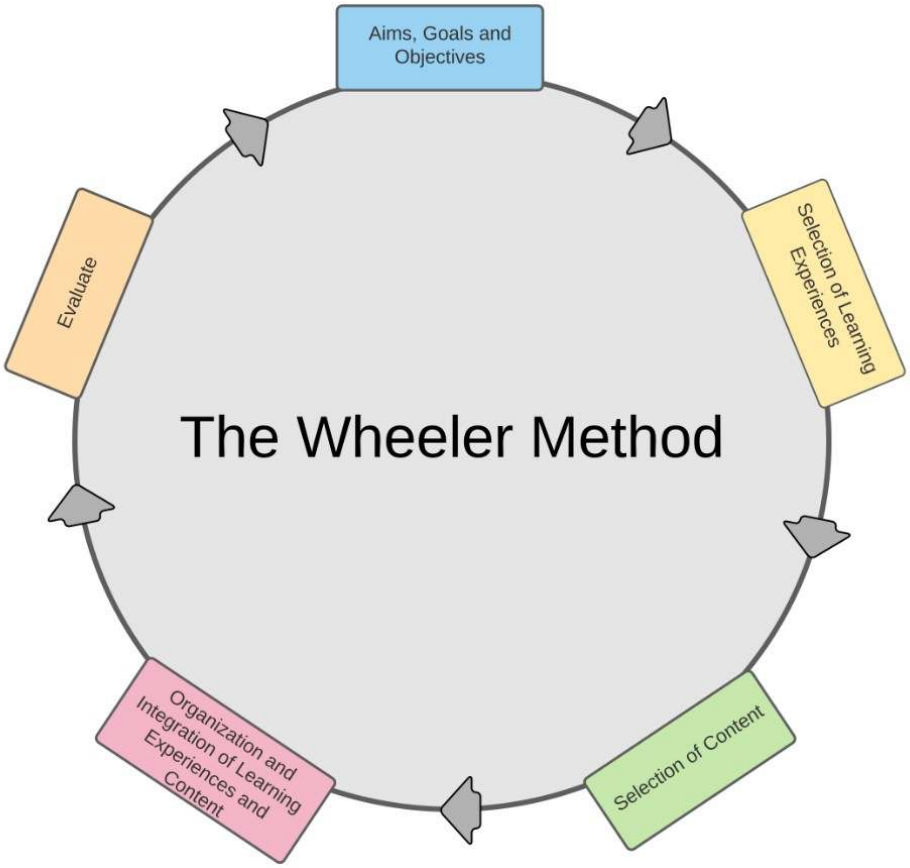

Figure 3: Wheeler Model

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Kerr's Model

John Kerr, a British Curriculum specialist in the 1960s, was particularly concerned with the following issues: objectives, knowledge, school learning experiences, and evaluation. This is reflected in the sketch below.

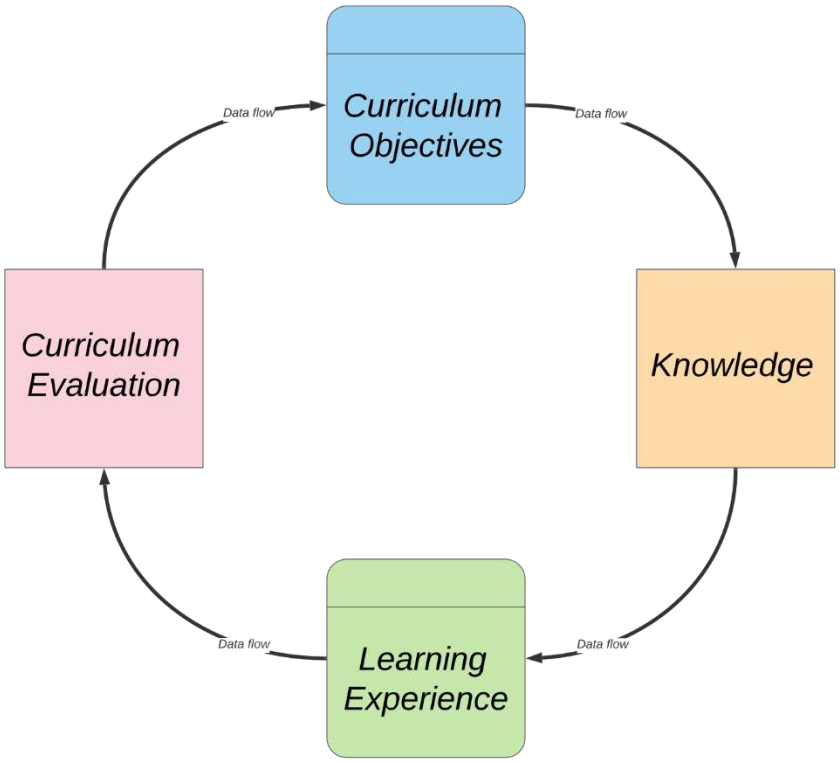

Figure 4: John Kerr's Model

Kerr's model is in many ways similar to that of Ralph Tyler and Wheeler. The difference is the emphasis on the interrelatedness of the various components in terms of the flow of the data between each component.

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Curriculum Implementation

Implementation is the act of putting the prescribed curriculum into practice in the school. It is the ultimate objective of curriculum development process because only after this has been done will learners have the opportunity to experience the curriculum and benefit from it.

Needless to say teachers are the implementers of curriculum and this is usually facilitated by Education Officers, Quality Assurance and Standards Officers (Q.A.S.O) and the school system steered by the principals / headteachers, deputy headteachers / principals, fellow teachers, teachers advisory centers (T.A.Cs) among others. Several essential steps should be taken to ensure effective implementation of the developed curriculum.

Curriculum Evaluation

The term “evaluation” generally applies to the process of making a value judgment. In education, the term “evaluation” is used in reference to operations associated with curricula, programs, interventions, methods of teaching and organizational factors.

Implementation of the curriculum needs to be monitored closely to ensure it is being used in the schools faithfully by the teachers as planned. The monitoring should focus on the objectives, content, methods of instruction and assessment procedures. Evaluation of the curriculum should be carried out after complete implementation. It is the process of assessing the extent to which curriculum objectives have been achieved or are being achieved.

Evaluation of curriculum is an integral and essential part of the whole process of curriculum development. It is a continuous activity and not a “tail-end-process”. Evaluation and planning are complementary processes which occur almost simultaneously and continuously.

Purpose of Curriculum Evaluation

The purpose to curriculum evaluation is to decide, what worked; what did not work; what needs to be modified; what needs to be rejected; what could be done differently next time.

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These can be re-stated as follows:

To determine the outcomes of a programme.

To help in deciding whether to accept or reject a programme.

To ascertain the need for the revision of the course content.

To help in future development of the curriculum material for continuous improvement.

To improve methods of teaching and instructional techniques

Types of Curriculum Evaluation

a) Diagnostic Evaluation

A diagnostic evaluation is a form of pre-assessment where implementers can evaluate the curriculum's strengths, weaknesses, knowledge and skills before their instruction formally begins. Diagnostic assessment helps both teachers and learners. Teachers are able to determine what students already know and develop lessons accordingly. Results of the evaluation may also help direct remediation support for students that need it to get them caught up with the rest of students in the course/program. With this form of evaluation, implementers can plan meaningful and efficient curriculum and can provide students with an individualized learning experience.

b) Formative Evaluation

A formative evaluation (sometimes referred to as internal) is a method for judging the worth of a program while the program activities are forming (in progress). Formative evaluation may include determining who needs the programme (e.g., secondary school students), how great is the need (e.g., students need to be taught ICT skills to keep pace with expansion of technology) and how to meet the need (e.g., introduce a subject on ICT compulsory for all secondary schools' students). In education, the aim of formative evaluation is usually to obtain information to improve a programme.

c) Summative Evaluation

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A summative evaluation (sometimes referred to as external) is a method of judging the worth of a program at the end of the program activities (summation). The focus is on the outcome. Summative evaluation can occur just after new curricula have been implemented in full (i.e., evaluate the effectiveness of the programme), or several months to years after the materials have been implemented in full. It is important to specify what questions you want answered by the evaluation and what decisions will be made as a result of the evaluation.

Formative	Determine learning progress, provide feedback for reinforcement of learning and correct learning errors.	Teacher-made mastery tests, observational techniques.
Summative	Determine end-of-course achievement for assigning grades or certifying mastery of objectives	Teacher-made tests, performance rating scales; product scales.
Diagnostic	Determine causes (intellectual, emotional & environmental) of persistent learning difficulties	Published diagnostic tests, teacher-made diagnostic tests.

Figure 5: Types of Curriculum Evaluation

Evaluation Methods and Tools

A variety of methods and tools can be used to conduct evaluations, including the following:

observations
interviews
tests
questionnaires.

The observation, interview and questionnaire techniques can be used when evaluating the entire curriculum as well as specific curriculum programmes or projects. One technique that is usually used to evaluate the outcomes of curriculum programmes is subjecting students to structured tests. Students' academic performance is usually evaluated by using this technique. Also, the content of a subject matter can be evaluated by testing students in its various content

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areas. Results from this type of evaluation are given to curriculum designers to enable them to review the subject areas affected and make necessary changes and improvements.

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Curriculum Change and Innovation

Concept and Theory of Change

Change can be categorized into two types.

Hardware Types. These changes are introduced by additions to facilities such as new classrooms, equipment, books and play grounds.

Software Types. These affect the content and range of the curriculum itself. They may be related to the methods of delivery recommended by curriculum initiators, designers and developer.

What is curriculum change

Change has been defined as embracing the concepts of innovation, development, renewal and improvement of a curriculum. Curriculum change is dictated by the changes in the economic, social and technological aspects of a society. Change has magnitude and direction and occurs within a definite time frame.

Forms of Change

Change can occur in the following forms

Substitution. In this change, one element replaces another previously in use. Examples are new textbooks, new equipment or the replacement of teachers and administrators.

Alteration. This involves change in existing structures rather than a complete replacement of the whole curriculum, syllabus or course of study.

Addition. This is the introduction of a new component without changing old elements or patterns. New elements are added to the existing programme without seriously disturbing the main structure and content of the prescribed curriculum. These could be support inputs such as audio-visual aids, workshops and equipment.

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Restructuring. This involves the rearrangement of the curriculum in order to implement desired changes. It may also involve the sharing of resources among a group of schools or institutions.

Strategies for Curriculum Change and Innovation

In order for change and innovation to succeed, the strategies for implementing the curriculum must be considered carefully. A strategy of innovation refers to the planned procedures and techniques employed in the quest for change.

Participative Problem-Solving. This strategy focuses on the users, their needs and how they satisfy these needs. The system identifies and diagnoses its own needs, finds its own solution, tries out and evaluates the solution and implements the solution if it is satisfactory. The emphasis is on local initiative.

Planned Linkage. In this model, the intermediate agencies, such as schools, bring together the users of the innovation.

Coercive Strategies. These strategies operate on the basis of power and coercion by those in authority, using laws, directories, circulars and so forth. Ministries of Education usually use these strategies.

Open Input Strategies. These are open, flexible, pragmatic approaches that make use of external ideas and resources.

Factors that influence curriculum change

Change and innovation in the curriculum are necessitated by factors in a country's:

political,
social,
economic,
cultural and
technological environments

The education system changes in order to address these emerging needs and demands. Educational changes and innovations in most countries, including Kenya, are products of these factors.

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Curriculum Change Agencies

Change agents include teachers, school heads, local authorities or the Ministry of Education. The agent initiates the innovation or curriculum change in general.

Curriculum innovation

Curriculum innovation is any improvement that is deliberate, measurable, durable and unlikely to occur frequently. It is the creation, selection, organisation and utilisation of human and material resources in ways that result in higher achievement of curriculum goals and objectives.

Is every change necessarily innovative? The difference between innovation and change lies in the fact that innovation is always planned while change may occur in response to external events. For any curriculum innovation to be meaningful and effective, it must be planned and organised. It is possible that other types of changes may occur when they are not planned.

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Curriculum Theory and Practice in Kenya

History of Curriculum Development in Kenya

Kenya 7–4–2–3 System

With the collapse of the East African community in 1977, Kenya continued with the same system of education but changed the examination names from their regional identity to a national identity. The East African Certificate of Primary Education became the Certificate of Primary Education (CPE), the first time the C.P.E was marked by a computer system, the East African Certificate of Education became the Kenya Certificate of Education (KCE) and the East African Advanced Certificate of Education became the Kenya Advanced Certificate of Education (KACE).

8–4–4 Curriculum

In 1985, President Daniel arap Moi introduced the 8–4–4 system of education, which adopted 8 years of primary education, 4 years of secondary education and 4 years of university education. With the introduction of the 8–4–4 system CPE became KCPE (Kenya Certificate of Primary Education) while KCE became the Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE).

Since 1985, public education in Kenya has been based on an 8–4–4 system,[3][4] with eight years of primary education followed by four years of secondary school and four years of college or university. To date, there has been steady growth in the advancement of education in the country. the country boasts of a great number of public and private universities as well as middle-level colleges.

Competency Based Curriculum (CBC) 2-6-3-3

In 2017, Kenya for the second time in history introduced a new system of education; the Competency Based Curriculum (CBC), to replace the traditional 8–4–4 system introduced by the late President Moi in 1985. The Competency based Curriculum was designed by the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD) with the aim of churning out ‘engaged, empowered and ethical citizens.

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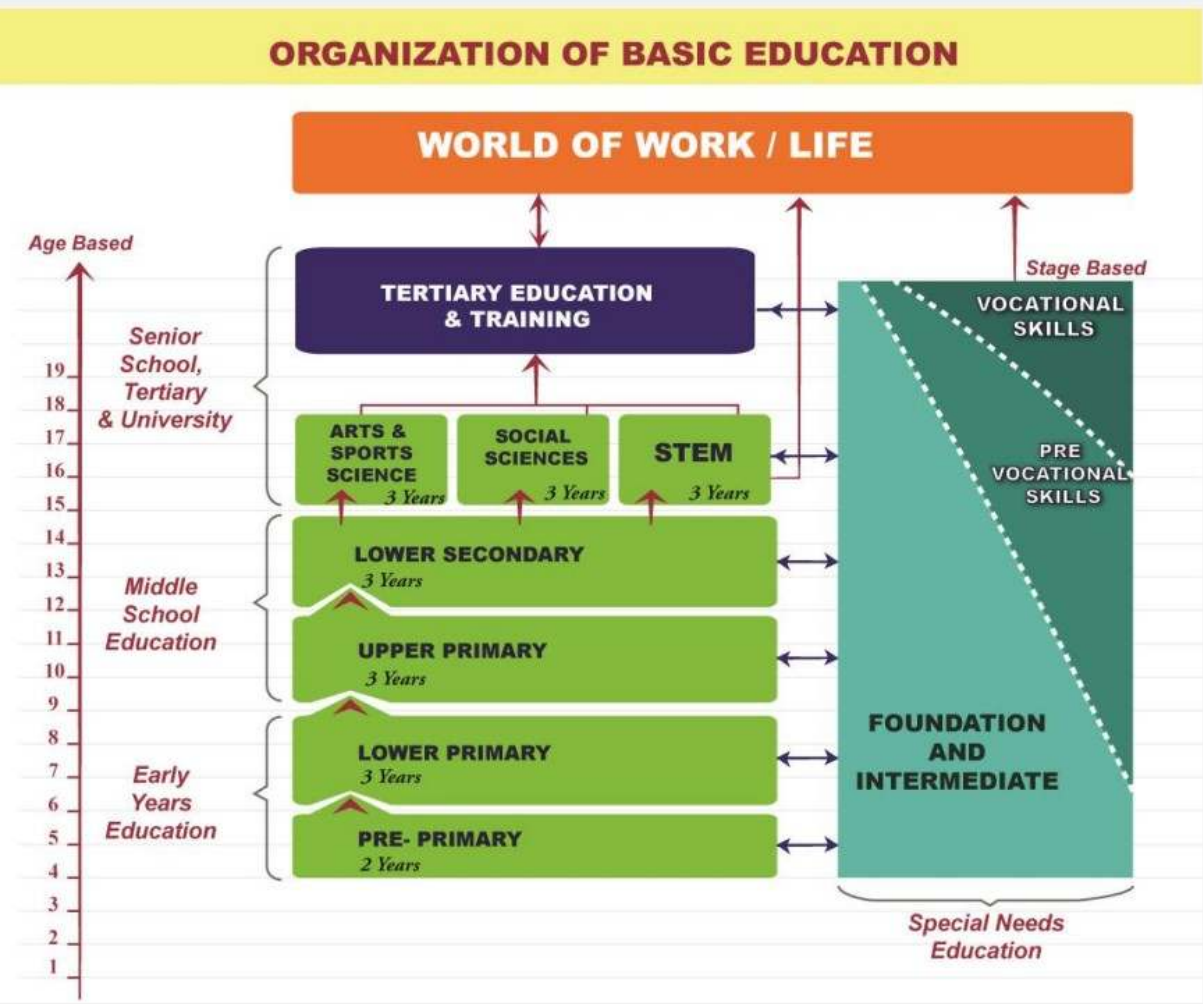
Current Structure of Education & Curriculum system in Kenya



The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development

The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD) was established by the Government of Kenya on the 14th of January 2013 under an Act of Parliament- Act No.4 of 2013. KICD is the Successor of the Kenya Institute of Education (KIE).

The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development is mandated to perform some of the following functions:

Advises the Government on matters pertaining to curriculum development

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Evaluate, vet and approve, for application in Kenya, any local and foreign curricula and curriculum support materials in relation to the levels of education and training”

Implement the policies relating to curriculum development in basic and tertiary education and training;

Develop, review and approve programs, curricula and curriculum support materials that meet international standards for—

Early childhood care, development and education;

Pre-primary education;

Primary education;

Secondary education;

Adult, continuing and non-formal education;

Teacher education and training;

Special needs education; and

Technical and vocational education and training.

Initiate and conduct research to inform curriculum policies, review and development.

Collect document and catalogue information on curricula, curriculum support materials and innovations to create a data bank and disseminate the information to educational institutions, learners and other relevant organizations

Print, publish and disseminate information relating to curricula for basic and tertiary education and training

Collaborate with other individuals and institutions in organizing and conducting professional development programs for teachers, teacher trainers, quality assurance and standards officers and other officers involved in education and training on curriculum programs and materials

Develop disseminate and transmit programs and curriculum support materials through mass media, electronic learning, distance learning and any other mode of delivering education and training programs and materials

Promote equity and access to quality curricula and curriculum support materials

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Promote appropriate utilization of technology to enhance innovations and achievement of a knowledge-based economy

Offer consultancy services in basic and tertiary education and training

Incorporate national values, talent development and leadership values in curriculum development

Receive, consider, develop and review curriculum proposals

The Kenya Institute of Education Curriculum Development Cycle

There are a number of processes involved in curriculum development exercise and they are as follows, extracted from the website of the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD).

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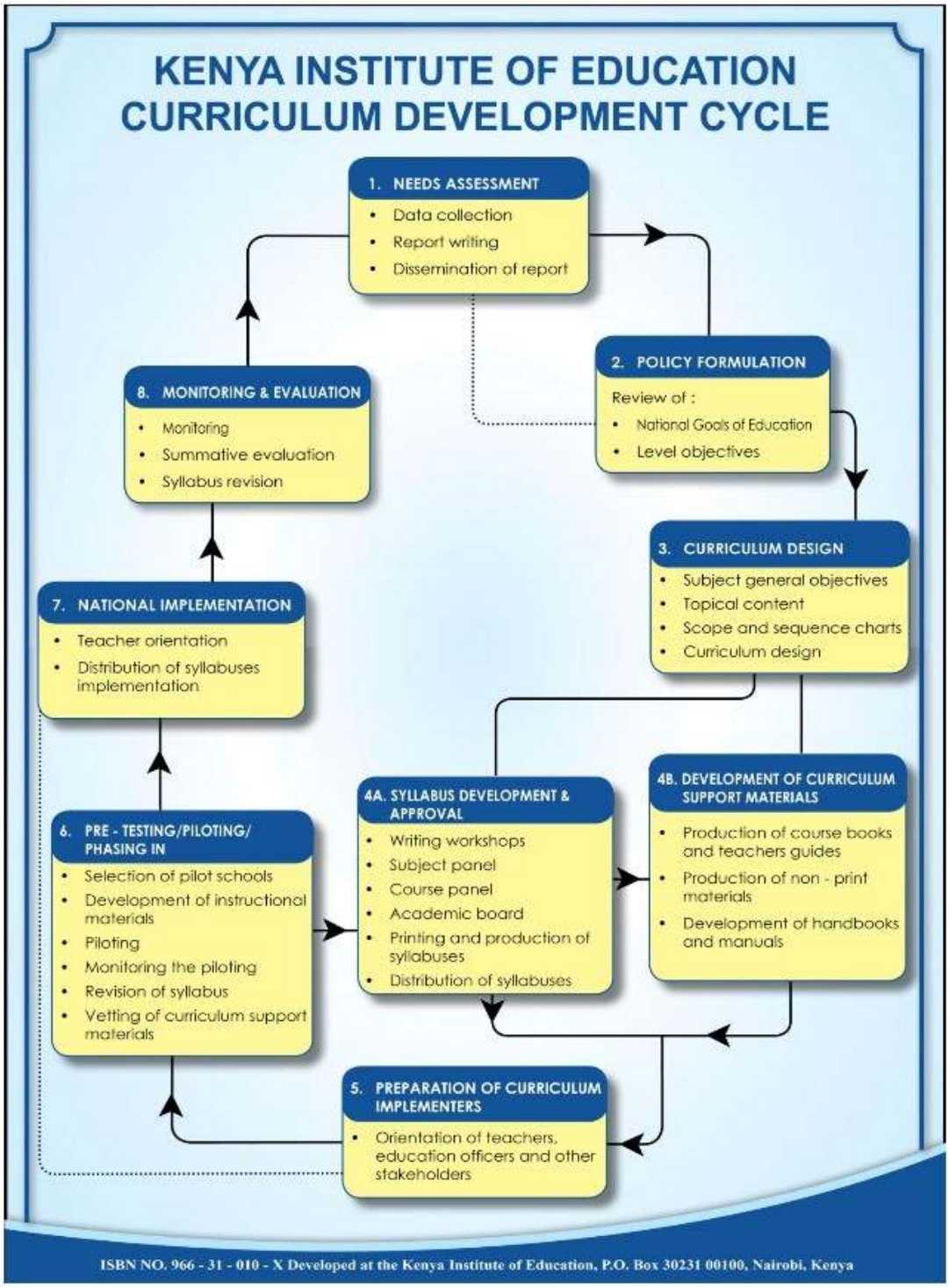

Figure 6: KICD Curriculum development Cycle

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Roles of the Teacher in Curriculum Development

Teacher education and curriculum development

Because teachers have to be involved in curriculum development, the teacher should be provided with appropriate knowledge and skills that help them to effectively contribute in curriculum development operation. As a result, teachers need training and workshops, which are geared toward professional development to be able to contribute to curriculum development. On the other hand, there is an important point to make efficient in involvement teacher in curriculum development that is teachers have to be empowered in the process of curriculum development (Carl, 2009). This means teachers should have improvement and increasing in many points of them, such as experience and autonomy. Thus, teachers play an integral part in the process of developing the curriculum; then students' outcomes.

Is the Teacher at the Receiving end?

The teacher involved in curriculum organization has many roles and responsibilities. Teachers want to enjoy teaching and watching their students develop interests and skills in their interest area. The teacher may need to create lesson plans and syllabi within the framework of the given curriculum since the teacher's responsibilities are to implement the curriculum to meet student needs (Carl, 2009). Many studies support empowerment of teachers through participation of curriculum development. For example, Fullan (1991) found that the level of teacher involvement as a center of curriculum development leads to effective achievement of educational reform. Therefore, the teacher is an important factor in the success of curriculum development including the steps of implication and evaluation. Handler (2010) also found that there is a need for teacher involvement in the development of curriculum. Teachers can contribute by collaboratively and effectively working with curriculum development teams and specialists to arrange and compose martial, textbooks, and content. Teacher involvement in the process of curriculum development is important to align content of curriculum with students needs in the classroom.

The teacher's hand in all curriculum activities

The most important person in the curriculum implementation process is the teacher. With their knowledge, experiences and competencies, teachers are central to any curriculum development effort.

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Better teachers support better learning because they are most knowledgeable about the practice of teaching and are responsible for introducing the curriculum in the classroom. If another party has already developed the curriculum, the teachers have to make an effort to know and understand it. So, teachers should be involved in curriculum development.

For example, teacher's opinions and ideas should be incorporated into the curriculum for development. On the other hand, the curriculum development team has to consider the teacher as part of the environment that affects curriculum (Carl, 2009).

Hence, teacher involvement is important for successful and meaningful curriculum development. Teachers being the implementers are part of the last stage of the curriculum development process.

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